



Sony Float Run headphones

Innovative headphones that nail the basics for the fitness enthusiasts

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Sony has been a brand that has a history of experimenting with the form factor of its personal audio products. In 2022, we saw the launch of the Sony Linkbuds, which created waves of excitement with their ring-shaped drivers. That concept, while in controlled environments, worked wonders; it struggled in more challenging situations. Now, after two years with the launch of the Sony Float Run headphones, the brand has introduced another pair of headphones with a unique form factor. They are calling it 'off-ear' headphones.

I got a chance to play around with these headphones when they showed

up at the Digit Test Centre. While at first, they look promising, some of the minor kinks in their armour show up on closer inspection. I could not evaluate them using our regular test process for in-ear or over-ear headphones; however, I put these headphones through their paces the best I could. So, before I reveal too much about these headphones, let's dive in and see how they fared –

A unique mix of innovation and comfort

Sony has never failed us when it comes to the build quality of their products, and the Float Run headphones are the same. While the

build is predominantly plastic, you will never be scared of these headphones breaking apart. The band connecting the two driver units is strong and held its own during my time of use. The colour combination of black and white on these headphones gives them a unique look but does not draw too much attention when out in public. You will turn a few heads, though, as these headphones are unique in their design. I was asked by a couple of people if they were hearing aids. So, you know what is coming your way. On a serious note, if I had to summarise their design in a single phrase, it would be – one design fits all.

Sony has applied the same philosophy in their fitting as well – one size fits all. The Sony Float Run headphones have a fixed-fit concept, which, in my experience, has worked well. I passed around these headphones at the Test Centre, and there were very few complaints I got about the fit of these headphones. The loop that goes around your ears has been modelled to fit the electronics for each driver, which is a smart move. It adds weight to the drivers in a good way, making them stick to your head when you are out for workouts. On that topic, the headphones are fairly lightweight, and the distribution of weights on them is also on point. If you are wearing them for long hours, you are not likely to face any discomfort.

The buttons are positioned on the right side and are integrated into the small control pod that sits behind your ear. Now, liking or disliking this placement is something that is going to be very subjective. However, I can say that the responsiveness of the controls and the ease of use are something that I love about these headphones.

In the box, you get a soft carrying pouch, which is a plus.

Features

In terms of features, there's not a whole lot to talk about with the Sony Float